

RAVI SHANKAR

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May 26, 2026

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

Personal Statement in Support of Form I-485 – Adjustment of Status

Following Approval of I-140 EB-1(A) Petition – Extraordinary Ability in Artificial Intelligence

I have lived and worked in Seattle since December 2019. I have maintained lawful immigration status continuously throughout that period, complied with all conditions of my admission, and have never had an overstay, a status violation, unauthorized employment, or any contact with the criminal justice system. That record is now six and a half years long.

I submit this statement under USCIS Policy Memorandum PM-602-0199 (May 21, 2026), which asks officers to affirmatively weigh the totality of an applicant's circumstances. I believe the affirmative case here is strong, and I want to lay it out plainly.

Why favorable discretion is warranted. My equities in the United States are substantial and concrete. I own a home at 2425 Eyres Place West in Seattle's Magnolia neighborhood, and my family is here. I have been employed, authorized, and paying taxes in Washington State for more than six consecutive years, first at Amazon and now as Executive Director at JPMorgan Chase, where I lead enterprise AI development. I have paid federal and state taxes throughout that period and have contributed to the U.S. economy as a senior technical leader at two of the country's most significant employers. My compensation in this role reflects an independent market assessment of that contribution: a base salary of \$325,000, which ranks at the 97th percentile among Executive Directors at JPMorgan Chase and at the 99th percentile for the same title at Morgan Stanley, based on public H-1B wage disclosure data. I intend to continue working in the same field of extraordinary ability in the United States. These are not equities assembled for this filing. They accumulated over years of lawful residence and reflect a family that has genuinely settled here.

Beyond the personal, there are affirmative public reasons to grant this application. For more than twelve years I have worked on one recurring problem: building AI systems that remain reliable when the environment is messy and the cost of error is high. In 2020 I built the machine learning system that Amazon used to detect price-gouged listings of masks and medical supplies during COVID-19, cited in Amazon's annual Shareholder Letter and formalized as U.S. Patent 11,756,049, with me as sole inventor. More recently, I built Q-SQL, a natural-language database system that surpassed models from Google, Databricks, Snowflake, ByteDance, and Tencent to reach the **#1 global ranking** on the BIRD benchmark — the industry-standard measure of enterprise AI accuracy — for over three months. That result was independently verified by the benchmark administrators through official test correspondence and confirmed on the public leaderboard; it is not an internal metric. Critically, Q-SQL achieved this with only 3 billion active parameters, at a training cost approximately 26 times lower than the nearest competing system, demonstrating that state-of-the-art AI capability can be built in a form that is deployable and cost-effective in real enterprise environments. The U.S. government has explicitly named maintaining American AI leadership as a national priority. At a time when competition for this capability is worldwide, that work was done here, by someone who has been here, and continuing it here is in the best interests of the United States. My current role at JPMorgan Chase continues it in a sector where reliable, auditable

AI carries real stakes. The approved EB-1A petition was supported by independent experts and even direct competitors.

Why consular processing would be disruptive without serving any real purpose. Consular processing would not materially assist adjudication of issues already documented in the record. What it would do is require a senior AI leader at a systemically important U.S. financial institution to interrupt active work and unsettle a household and employment situation that has been stable and lawful for over six years. The disruption would be real. The adjudicative benefit would be minimal. In these circumstances, adjustment of status is the more practical and less disruptive path.

I am available for interview or to provide any documentation the Officer requires.

Respectfully,

Ravi Shankar

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